City of Saint Paul

Meeting Minutes

City Council

City Hall and Court House
15 West Kellogg Boulevard
Council Chambers - 3rd Floor
651-266-8560

Council President Rebecca Noecker
Vice President Nelsie Yang
Councilmember Anika Bowie
Councilmember Molly Coleman
Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson
Councilmember Saura Jost
Councilmember HwaJeong Kim

Wednesday, March 11, 2026 **3:30 PM** **Council Chambers - 3rd Floor**

ROLL CALL

Meeting started at 3:32 PM

Present 7 - Councilmember Rebecca Noecker, Councilmember Nelsie Yang, Councilmember HwaJeong Kim, Councilmember Anika Bowie, Councilmember Saura Jost, Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson and Councilmember Molly Coleman

COMMUNICATIONS & RECEIVE/FILE

1 AO 26-18 Authorizing the Police Department to reallocate activity budget to more accurately record grant awards from the Saint Paul Police Foundation.

Received and Filed

CONSENT AGENDA
Items listed under the Consent Agenda will be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. If discussion on an item is desired, the item will be removed from the Consent Agenda for separate consideration.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Consent Agenda adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

2 RES 26-117 Approving the City's cost of providing Removal of Diseased and/or Dangerous Tree(s) in November and December 2025, and setting date of Legislative Hearing for April 7, 2026 and City Council public hearing for May 13, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. 2603T, Assessment No. 269002)

Adopted

3 RES 26-364 Establishing the rate of pay for Water Control Systems Information Analyst, Grade 046, Employee Group 02.

Laid over to March 18, 2026

4 RES 26-374 Approving the appointment of Dillon Donnelly as community advisor to the Audit Committee and as a non-voting member for a term of three years.

Adopted

5 RES 26-378 Approving the release of a water utility easement, in the name of the City, located on property at 893 Tanglewood Drive, Shoreview, MN.

Adopted

6 RES 26-379 Authorizing the Fire Department to enter into a lease agreement with Dell Financial Services (that includes an indemnification clause).

Adopted

7 RES 26-385 Approving the City's cost of providing Collection of Delinquent Garbage Bills for service during July to September 2025, and setting date of legislative hearing for March 19, 2026 and City Council public hearing for April 15, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. CG25Q3B1, Assessment No. 260130)

Adopted

8 RES 26-387 Approving the City's cost of providing Collection of Delinquent Garbage Bills for service during July to September 2025, and setting date of legislative hearing for March 19, 2026 and City Council public hearing for April 15, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. CG25Q3B2, Assessment No. 260131)

Adopted

9 RES 26-393 Authorizing payment in the amount of $16,000.00 in full and final settlement of the claim of Jarell Heads.

Adopted

10 RES 26-394 Authorizing payment in the amount of $25,000.00 in full and final settlement of the claim of Jacob Olmstead.

Adopted

11 RES 26-395 Approving the City's cost of providing Collection of Delinquent Garbage Bills for service during July to September 2025, and setting date of legislative hearing for March 19, 2026 and City Council public hearing for April 15, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. CG25Q3B3, Assessment No. 260132)

Adopted

12 RES 26-397 Approving the City's cost of providing Collection of Delinquent Garbage Bills for service during July to September 2025, and setting date of legislative hearing for March 19, 2026 and City Council public hearing for April 15, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. CG25Q3B4, Assessment No. 260133)

Adopted

13 RES 26-398 Approving the City's cost of providing Collection of Delinquent Garbage Bills for service during July to September 2025, and setting date of legislative hearing for March 19, 2026 and City Council public hearing for April 15, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. CG25Q3B5, Assessment No. 260134)

Adopted

14 RES 26-399 Approving the City's cost of providing Collection of Delinquent Yard Waste Bills for service during July to September 2025, and setting date of legislative hearing for March 19, 2026 and City Council public hearing for April 15, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. YW25Q3B1, Assessment No. 250501)

Adopted

15 RES 26-307 Approving the Collective Bargaining Agreements (January 1, 2026 - December 31, 2028) and Memorandums of Agreement between the City of Saint Paul and AFSCME Council 5, Clerical - Local 2508 and Technical - Local 1842.

Adopted

FOR DISCUSSION

16 RES PH 26-59 Authorizing the write off of Police staffing costs for qualifying free public cultural festivals and community events.

Councilmembers Bowie, Johnson, Yang gave remarks.

Bowie withdrew the item.

Withdrawn

ORDINANCES

An ordinance is a city law enacted by the City Council. It is read at three separate council meetings and becomes effective after passage by the Council and 30 days after publication in the Saint Paul Pioneer Press. Public hearings on ordinances are generally held at the second reading.

First Reading

17 Ord 26-17 Administrative Ordinance establishing the minimum qualifications for the vacancy for the position of Fire Chief pursuant to the provisions of Section 12.12.1 of the City Charter.

Laid over to March 18, 2026 for Second Reading

PUBLIC HEARINGS

Live testimony is limited to two minutes for each person. See below for optional ways to testify.

18 Ord 26-16 Granting the application of Xcel Energy to rezone property at 325 Commercial St from H1 Residential to I1 Light Industrial and amending Chapter 60 of the Legislative Code pertaining to the Zoning Map.

Councilmember Johnson moved to close the public hearing.

Laid over to March 18, 2026 for Final Adoption

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

19 Ord 26-18 Amending Section 193.04 of the Legislative Code (Title XIX) to temporarily extend the pre-eviction notice period in Section 193.04 from 30-days to 60-days.

Councilmember Kim gave remarks and moved Version 2. Approved 7-0.

16 people spoke during the public hearing.

Kim moved to close the public hearing.

Amended and laid over to March 18, 2026 for Final Adoption

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

20 RES PH 26-56 Approving the application of MN Run Series, Podium Sports Marketing for a sound level variance in order to present amplified sound for the Mightyssippi 10 Mile event on Saturday, June 6, 2026, at 226 Spring Street-Upper Landing Park and at 25 Mississippi River Boulevard-connected to Shadow Falls Park.

Councilmember Coleman moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

21 RES PH 26-65 Authorizing the City to amend project and accounting unit budgets in City special funds to align with the 2026 Adopted Budget.

Councilmember Johnson moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

22 ABZA 26-3 Considering the appeal of a decision by the Board of Zoning Appeals denying two variances from City Council Resolution 23-1442 for a hotel at United Village Block D (where 43.1% window and door openings are proposed for façade length [a 6.9% variance] and 23.3% for façade area [a 6.7% variance], below the required 50% and 30%) at 1560 University Avenue West.

YaYa Diatta and Kaozouapang Yang from the Department of Safety and Inspections gave a staff report and answered councilmember questions.

Mike Hahm spoke during the public hearing on behalf of the appellant.

Mark Morel from the Union Park District Council spoke during the public hearing.

Councilmember Bowie moved to close the public hearing. Approved 7-0.

Bowie moved to grant the appeal and spoke in favor.

Councilmember Coleman spoke in favor.

Motion of intent is the appeal is granted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

23 PH 26-4 Public hearing on grievances about federal immigration operations.

Councilmember Yang gave remarks and moved to continue the public hearing for one week.

Public hearing continued to March 18, 2026

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

LEGISLATIVE HEARING CONSENT AGENDA

Items listed under the Consent Agenda will receive a combined public hearing and be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. Items may be removed from the Consent Agenda for a separate public hearing and discussion if desired.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Councilmember Jost moved approval.

Legislative Hearing Consent Agenda adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

24 RLH SAO 26-16 Appeal of Victoria Pwo, on behalf of Nyar Pwo, to a Summary Abatement Order at 399 BLAIR AVENUE.

Adopted

25 RLH VO 26-12 Appeal of Nikolla Erindi, on behalf of Elton Mykerezi, to a Fire Inspection Correction Notice, which includes condemnation, at 104 DALE STREET NORTH.

Adopted

26 RLH VO 26-13 Appeal of Janice Ruchie, Occupant, to a Fire Inspection Report, which includes condemnation, at 1877 GRAND AVENUE, APARTMENT 1.

Adopted

ADJOURNMENT

Meeting ended at 4:55 PM

City Council meetings are open for in person attendance, but the public may also comment on public hearing items in writing. Any comments and materials submitted by 12:00 pm of the day before the meeting will be attached to the public record and available for review by the City Council. Comments may be submitted as follows:

Written public comment on public hearing items can be submitted to Contact-Council@ci.stpaul.mn.us or CouncilHearing@ci.stpaul.mn.us. Live testimony will be taken in person in the Council Chambers.

Council Meeting Information
The City Council is paperless which saves the environment and reduces expenses. The agendas and Council files are all available on the Web (see below). Council members use mobile devices to review the files during the meeting. Using a mobile device greatly reduces costs since most agendas, including the documents attached to files, are over 1000 pages when printed.

Web
Meetings are available on the Council's website. Email notification and web feeds (RSS) of newly released minutes, agendas, and meetings are available by subscription. Visit www.stpaul.gov/council for meeting videos and updated copies of the agendas, minutes, and supporting documents.

Cable
Meetings are live on St Paul Channel 18 and replayed at various times. Check your local listings.